My relationship with God has never been something I could explain in a neat little paragraph.

My faith matters to me, and I don't say that casually. But I have also found myself thinking about experiences that don't fit comfortably into the language I grew up using to understand the world.

Not because I want to replace what I believe. Quite the opposite, actually. Sometimes, the more I think about faith, the more questions I find myself asking.

And I don't always know what to do with those questions.

Growing up around religion, or even coming to faith later in life, can give you a vocabulary for certain things. You learn about prayer, grace, sin, obedience, spiritual warfare, and the importance of trusting God. You learn how to interpret certain experiences and what to do when life becomes difficult.

These teachings can offer tremendous comfort. They can give people a sense of direction when everything feels uncertain. They can help us make sense of suffering, confront our shortcomings, and remember that our lives are part of something bigger than our immediate circumstances.

Still, human experience is a rather untidy thing.

Sometimes, you pray and feel peace. Other times, you pray and your mind remains as noisy as a matatu stage at five in the evening. Sometimes, you read scripture and a particular passage seems to speak directly to what you are going through. On another day, you read the same passage three times and your brain is busy remembering an embarrassing thing you said in 2017.

Faith does not always arrive with the emotional confirmation we expect.

And I wonder how many of us have quietly worried about that.

We can become so concerned with having the correct spiritual experience that we start evaluating ourselves while we are supposed to be seeking God. Was that feeling the Holy Spirit? Was that thought my own? Did I pray properly? Why does someone else seem to experience God so vividly while I am here trying to concentrate for five consecutive minutes?

We turn spirituality into another area of life where we feel we must perform well.

Yet, if faith is a relationship with God, surely it must allow room for honesty. Not the kind of honesty that only exists in carefully selected testimonies, where every struggle eventually produces a beautiful lesson and everyone lives happily ever after. I mean the honesty of admitting that you do not understand something, that you are confused, or that your experience of God does not always resemble the descriptions you hear from other people.

I don't think asking questions automatically makes a person less faithful.

Sometimes, it means they are taking their faith seriously enough to examine what they believe, why they believe it, and how those beliefs shape the way they live.

I have become interested in the things people experience but struggle to explain. The moments that leave them thoughtful long after they have passed. The feelings they cannot immediately place. The experiences that seem meaningful, even when they cannot confidently say what those experiences mean.

People have different ways of understanding these things. Some approach them through religion. Others use psychology, philosophy, cultural traditions, or personal reflection. Some draw from several of these perspectives at once.

I find that interesting because we are often encouraged to choose a single vocabulary for experiences that may be more complicated than the words available to us.

If you are religious, you may feel pressure to explain everything through scripture. If you are interested in spirituality, you may be tempted to interpret every unusual experience as a sign. If you approach life scientifically, you may feel that acknowledging something as personally meaningful is equivalent to making a claim you cannot prove.

Yet an experience can matter to you without giving you permission to declare exactly what caused it.

That distinction is important to me.

I can acknowledge that something affected me deeply without pretending to know every reason it happened. I can be curious about an experience without building an entire belief system around it. I can pray about something and remain open to the possibility that my understanding of it is incomplete.

Uncertainty does not have to be an emergency.

Perhaps one of the difficulties we encounter when discussing spirituality is our desire to name things immediately. We want to know whether something was divine, psychological, coincidental, or simply part of being human. We want the answer because an answer gives us somewhere to stand.

And sometimes, we want an answer because the alternative is admitting that we don't know.

That can be uncomfortable, especially when the subject is God.

We want to feel certain that we are hearing Him correctly. We want to know whether a particular opportunity is meant for us, whether a difficult season has a spiritual purpose, whether a

decision is wise, and whether the things happening around us carry a meaning we have yet to discover.

I understand the desire. When something matters deeply, we naturally want to make the right choice.

But I sometimes wonder whether our need to interpret every detail can distract us from the faith we are trying to practise.

Must every coincidence carry a message? Must every delay mean that God is redirecting us? Must every difficult person be a spiritual lesson? Must every unusual dream be decoded before breakfast?

Some things may hold personal meaning. Others may be ordinary events that we are trying to understand through the circumstances of our lives. We don't always have to settle the question immediately.

And I would be cautious about anyone who claims to have a definitive spiritual explanation for every event in another person's life.

Human beings are capable of attaching extraordinary certainty to things they cannot actually know. We can convince ourselves that a feeling is divine instruction, that an unfortunate event proves somebody has evil intentions, or that a particular outcome confirms our interpretation of God's will.

The confidence can be impressive. The evidence, occasionally, is on leave.

Our faith deserves better than that.

Believing in God does not require me to pretend that every thought passing through my mind comes from Him. Nor does being open to spiritual experiences require me to abandon common sense. Prayer and practical responsibility are not enemies. Seeking spiritual guidance does not mean refusing to ask questions, examine evidence, or listen to wise counsel.

I can pray about a decision and still do my research.

I can trust God and still acknowledge that I may have misunderstood a situation.

I can believe that God is present in my life without assuming that I have correctly interpreted every event in it.

For me, these distinctions make faith more honest, not less meaningful.

They also make room for a relationship with God that isn't entirely dependent on dramatic moments.

We hear powerful testimonies about answered prayers, extraordinary encounters, and experiences that transform people's lives. Those stories can be moving. They can strengthen faith and remind us that people experience their relationship with God in deeply personal ways.

But what about the ordinary days?

The mornings when nothing remarkable happens. The prayers that consist of a few tired sentences whispered before sleep. The moments when you choose to tell the truth even though lying would be easier. The decision to apologise when your pride would prefer to prepare a closing argument. The quiet effort to become more patient, more generous, and less determined to have the last word.

These things may not make for particularly exciting testimonies, but they matter.

Sometimes, I think we can become so fascinated by extraordinary spiritual experiences that we overlook the ordinary work of living according to what we claim to believe.

It is possible to know all the right religious language and still treat people terribly. You can speak passionately about spiritual maturity while refusing to take responsibility for your behaviour. You can spend hours discussing discernment and still be unwilling to admit when you are wrong.

The vocabulary of faith is not the same thing as the practice of faith.

And I say that knowing that none of us gets it right all the time. I certainly don't think faith makes a person immune to selfishness, confusion, or poor decisions. If anything, taking your beliefs seriously should make you more willing to examine yourself.

What does my faith produce in me?

Am I becoming more compassionate, or am I simply becoming more confident that I am right? Am I learning humility, or have I found religious language that allows me to avoid accountability? Does my understanding of God make me more willing to love people, or do I use it to decide who deserves my kindness?

Those questions interest me more than whether I can give an impressive explanation for an unusual experience.

Because whatever else we say about spirituality, it eventually meets us in the way we live.

It meets us in how we handle disappointment, how we treat people who cannot benefit us, what we do with our anger, and whether we can remain honest when dishonesty would be convenient. It meets us when we have to make a difficult choice without receiving a clear answer about what the future holds.

And perhaps that is where faith becomes particularly personal.

Not because we suddenly understand everything, but because we learn how to live without understanding everything.

I am still interested in the experiences that make me pause and wonder. I am still curious about the parts of human life that resist easy explanation. I don't believe that everything meaningful must be reduced to a simplistic explanation, and I don't believe that every unanswered question must be filled with a supernatural one.

I want room for faith and curiosity to sit at the same table.

I want to be able to talk about God without pretending to have mastered the mystery of Him. I want to acknowledge the limits of my understanding without feeling that I have somehow failed spiritually. I want to remain open to learning, including learning that something I once interpreted one way may have been more complicated than I realised.

And I want to remember that my experience of God is personal, but it does not make me the authority on everybody else's experience.

Someone else's faith may look different from mine. They may describe their relationship with God in language I would not naturally use. They may have questions I have never considered. Their experiences may not resemble mine at all.

I can listen without immediately trying to correct them. I can disagree without assuming that I understand their spiritual life better than they do. And I can recognise that not every difference in how we describe an experience needs to become a competition over who is closer to God.

We already have enough competitions in this world. We don't need a spiritual Olympics.

What I keep returning to is the possibility that faith can be both deeply rooted and open to reflection. That believing in God does not mean I must have an immediate explanation for everything I encounter. That curiosity does not automatically threaten conviction, and that humility includes recognising when I am speaking from belief, when I am speaking from personal experience, and when I simply do not know.

I may never find the perfect language for every experience that shapes my spiritual life.

Perhaps that is all right.

I don't need to turn every question into a conclusion. I don't need to make every moment fit into a neat narrative. And I don't need to pretend that the mystery disappears simply because I have found a word for it.

I believe in God. I believe in Christ. I am still learning what my faith asks of me, what it reveals about me, and how to live it with greater honesty.
For now, I am comfortable admitting that there are things I believe, things I am still trying to

understand, and things I may never fully explain.

I would rather approach God with that honesty than spend my life pretending I have answers I don't possess.